

Mrs. Harrison
Middle School Social Studies
Mary, Star of the Sea School
Email: sharrison@starofthesea.org
MSOS 2026-2027

Social Studies — Grade 8 Syllabus

Grade 8 • U.S. History: Industrial Age to Modern Human Rights • SY 2026-2027

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

"I ka wā ma mua, ka wā ma hope." — The future is found in the past.

Welcome to Social Studies

Welcome to Social Studies! Our focus this school year will be learning and developing our skills as critical thinkers, readers, writers, speakers, and listeners. The development and mastery of these important skills is not only important to achieving success in all school subjects, building strong relationships with others, and attaining a flourishing career as an adult.

Basically, the quality of life you experience now through adulthood will depend a lot on how well you read, write, and communicate with others.

Teacher

Mrs. Harrison • sharrison@starofthesea.org

Office Hours: Available during recesses (when not on duty), before, or after school. Please make an appointment.

I will respond within 24 hours of an email. I do not respond after 6:30 p.m. unless there is an emergency.

Supplies

- Textbook
- Pencils
- Folder paper

- Markers or crayons (sometimes)
- Glue
- MacBook (charged daily)

Grade 8 Goal — Critical Citizenship

By the end of Grade 8 , students will:

- Demonstrate a deep understanding of U.S. history from the Westward Expansion to modern day human rights.
- Analyze how historical events, laws, and movements shape government, rights, and responsibilities in a democratic society.
- Synthesize information from multiple sources to form and defend reasoned arguments about historical and civic issues.
- Apply historical thinking skills to current events, recognizing patterns, causes, and consequences.

Areas of Concentration — Grade 8

Westward Expansion to Industrial Revolution to WWI to WWII; Korean Conflict; Vietnam War; to Human Rights.

- Unit 1 — Industrial Revolution & Urban America
- Unit 2 — World War I (1914–1918)
- Unit 3 — World War II (1939–1945)
- Unit 4 — Cold War: Korea & Vietnam
- Unit 5 — Civil Rights & Modern Human Rights

How will I be graded this year?

Category	Weight	Notes
AOW — Article of the Week	15%	5 pts each
Classwork — Summaries / Notes	30%	4 pts each
Projects	30%	Start Q2 · 25 pts each
Quizzes	15%	5–10 pts each
Active Learning	10%	2 pts / class day

AOW — Article of the Week (15%)

5 points each. A weekly writing response students complete on their Google Drive account.

A poem, story, or article will be given on Mondays. Your response is due on Fridays.

Your response should include:

- Any part of the article you liked, disliked, or were confused about.
- WHY did you like, dislike, or were confused about this part.
- Length is not as important as the amount of details and explanations you write about.

Classwork — Summaries & Notes (30%)

4 points each. To show me that you understand the information you received in class, you may be asked to write a summary about the material.

Sometimes, the summaries will be counted as a quiz.

Essays

You will be given a grading rubric before the essays are given. When we begin a unit, you will be given an essential question for the essay.

We will be working on our answers to the essential questions together throughout the unit.

Projects (30%)

25 points each. Projects start during the 2nd quarter.

Projects follow the same guidelines as the essays — rubric provided ahead of time, anchored to a unit's essential question.

Quizzes (15%)

5–10 points each. Used to check understanding throughout each unit.

Active Learning (10%)

2 points each class day. Participation is based on coming to class prepared:

- MacBook charged
- Learning materials prepared
- Assignments completed
- Ready for class discussions
- Being an attentive listener
- Actively engaged in class

What happens if I turn in an assignment late?

- Work not completed and turned in by the assigned date is considered late.
- If a student is absent on the date work is due, the assignment is due within a week from the absence.
- There is no penalty in your homework grade for an assignment turned in late, as long as it is turned in. However, there will be a deduction in your Active Learning grade.
- If you do not turn in an assignment, your score will not be added into your grade.
- A late assignment is better than a missing assignment.

Classwork Grading Scale

4	Exceeds expectations
3	Meets expectations
2	Emerging towards expectations
1	Far below expectations / incomplete

Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith